Distributor Locator

How to install the plugin, what every setting does, and the decisions worth making carefully before your locator goes live.

GUIDE	DATE	APPLIES TO
Installation & Settings, version 1.0	17 August 2026	Plugin version 0.6.0

> **Who this guide is for.** Whoever installs the locator and sets it up — a site administrator, a marketing manager, or an IT colleague. It assumes you can find your way around the WordPress admin area, but nothing beyond that.
>
> Three tasks genuinely need a developer or your web host: the Google Maps account, email delivery, and storing the HubSpot key securely. Each is marked clearly so you know when to hand over.

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Sections 1 to 4 install the locator. Sections 5 to 8 explain every setting. Section 11 is the part worth reading twice.

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Section 1

Before you start

The locator does not work alone. Three other plugins must be installed and switched on first, and one of them is more important than it looks.

The three plugins it depends on

PLUGIN	WHAT IT DOES FOR THE LOCATOR
Toolset Types	Holds the structure of your distributor records — the company name, phone, website, and the five email addresses. **Without it, the locator has nothing to display.**
Gravity Forms	Provides the Request Quote form that opens when a customer clicks the button.
Gravity Forms Webhooks	An add-on for Gravity Forms. It carries enquiries across to HubSpot. Only needed if you are using the HubSpot connection.

Check all three under **Plugins** and make sure each is active before going any further.

> **THE ONE TO BE CAREFUL WITH**
>
> **Toolset Types is not optional and cannot be swapped out.** It is where the shape of your distributor records is stored. If someone deactivates it, the Distributors menu vanishes and the locator empties out.
>
> Your data is not lost when that happens — everything returns the moment Types is switched back on — but the website is visibly broken in the meantime. It is worth telling anyone else with admin access.

What your hosting needs

- **A secure site (HTTPS).** Both Google Maps and HubSpot require it.
- **A reasonably modern server.** Your host will know what PHP 8.1 or newer means; most hosting has been on it for years.
- **Scheduled tasks working normally.** The locator uses WordPress's built-in scheduler to place map pins in the background.

Take a backup

Before installing anything, take a full backup of the site — files and database. Your host almost certainly offers this in one click. Nothing in this guide is destructive, but the habit is worth keeping.

Section 2

Installing the plugin

If your site is being moved across from a staging or development version, most of this is already done for you — skip to Section 5 and check the settings instead.

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1. **Go to Plugins → Add New → Upload Plugin.**

   Choose the plugin ZIP file you were supplied and click Install Now.

2. **Click Activate.**

   Behind the scenes this creates the storage the locator needs — one place for distributor addresses, one for the areas they cover, and one for a record of enquiries. Nothing is asked of you.

3. **Confirm it worked.**

   A new **Distributors** menu should appear in the left-hand sidebar. If it does not, the most likely reason is that Toolset Types is not active — see Section 1.

4. **Load your distributor data, if the site is new.**

   If you are starting fresh rather than copying an existing site, this is the point to import distributors from a spreadsheet. Ask whoever supplied the plugin for the export file — it saves re-entering 164 companies by hand.

5. **Move on to the settings.**

   Go to **Distributors → Settings**. Sections 5 to 8 of this guide walk through that screen field by field.

> **A NOTE ON UPDATES**
>
> When a new version of the plugin is supplied, install it the same way — upload and activate over the top. Your distributors, addresses, service areas, and settings are all kept. Take a backup first out of habit.

Section 3

Putting the locator on a page

The locator appears wherever you place a short piece of text called a shortcode. Usually that is a dedicated “Find a Distributor” page.

The basic method

1. **Create or edit the page** where the locator should appear.
2. **Add a Shortcode block** and type `[tdl_locator]` into it.
3. **Publish the page** and view it. The search box, list, and map should all appear.
4. **Add the page to your site menu** so customers can find it.

Optional adjustments

You can change how the locator behaves on a particular page by adding options inside the shortcode. Most sites never need these — the settings screen covers the same ground for the whole site — but they are useful if you want a second, simpler version somewhere.

OPTION	WHAT IT DOES
`map_height`	Makes the map taller or shorter. The default is 600 pixels.
`show_map`	Set to `false` for a list with no map.
`show_list`	Set to `false` for a map with no list.
`default_country`	Starts the page filtered to one country, for example `US`.
`results_per_page`	Overrides how many results appear per page.
`zoom`	How far in the map is zoomed when the page loads.
`center_lat` / `center_lng`	Where the map is centred when the page loads.

EXAMPLE

A taller map, showing only US distributors when the page first loads:

```
[tdl_locator map_height="700px" default_country="US"]
```

Section 4

A tour of the admin area

Everything to do with the locator lives under one menu, called **Distributors**.

MENU ITEM	WHAT IT IS FOR
All Distributors	The full list of companies. Search it, sort it, filter it, and click any name to edit.
Add New	Create a new distributor.
Settings	Everything in Sections 5 to 8 of this guide.
Routing Log	A record of every customer enquiry and where it was sent. Your first stop whenever anything seems wrong.
Geocoding Status	Map pins — how many addresses have been placed, and a button to place the rest.
Import CSV	Add or update many distributors at once from a spreadsheet.
Export CSV	Download everything to a spreadsheet. Useful as a backup.

You may also see **M2 Initial Import**. That was used once to load the original distributor list and is not needed again — please leave it alone.

What a distributor record contains

Open any company from the list and you will find four groups of information:

- **Contact details** — phone, website, and five email addresses: main, sales, parts, service, and installations.
- **Physical Locations** — their actual address or addresses. This is what puts a pin on the map.
- **Service Zones** — the ZIP codes, states, or countries they are allowed to sell into. This is what makes them appear in a search.
- **Parent Distributor** — used when a company is a branch of a larger one already in the list.

The difference between the second and third of these matters a great deal, and Section 11 comes back to it.

Section 5

Settings: map and general

Go to **Distributors** → **Settings**. The first group of fields controls the map and how results are presented. Remember to click Save Changes at the bottom.

Map Provider

Two choices:

- **Google Maps** — the familiar map most visitors expect. Requires a Google account with billing enabled, and this is what your site is set up to use.
- **OpenStreetMap** — a free alternative that needs no account and no billing. Perfectly usable, and a sensible fallback if the Google account ever lapses, but less polished.

Google Maps API Key DEVELOPER

A long code that identifies your Google account to the map service. Without it, the map area stays blank.

Getting one involves creating a project in Google Cloud, enabling billing, and switching on three services. This is a job for your developer or IT team — and there are two safety measures they should apply that are covered in Section 11.

Google Map ID DEVELOPER

A second, shorter code from the same Google account. It controls the map's visual style, and the map pins will not appear without it. It comes from the same place as the key.

Default Map Zoom

How far in the map is zoomed before anyone searches, from 1 (the whole world) to 20 (a single street). Your site uses **5**, which shows most of North America.

Default Map Centre

Two numbers giving the point the map is centred on when the page loads. Yours is set near Rockton, Illinois. You would only change these to shift the opening view toward a different region.

Results Per Page

How many distributors appear before the visitor has to click through to the next page. The default is **20**. Higher numbers mean more scrolling and a slower page; lower numbers mean more clicking.

Show City / Region Tab

Adds a fourth way to search, alongside ZIP code, state, and country. It is currently **switched off**. Some visitors find searching by city natural; others find four options one too many. It is a genuine preference — try it and see.

Cache Duration

To keep the locator fast, search results are remembered for a short time rather than recalculated for every visitor. This setting is how long, in minutes. The default of **60** is a good balance and there is rarely a reason to change it.

Edits you make to a distributor appear straight away regardless — the locator notices your changes and refreshes itself.

Clear Search Cache

A button rather than a setting. Click it if you have changed distributor data outside the normal admin screens — after a spreadsheet import, for instance — and the website is still showing the old version.

Section 6

Settings: enquiry emails

This short group of settings controls what happens when a customer submits the Request Quote form.

How enquiries are routed

You do not configure the destination here, and that is deliberate. Each enquiry goes to the distributor the customer was actually looking at, using the addresses on that distributor's own record:

- First choice: that distributor's **sales email**.
- If that is empty: their **main email**, and a warning is recorded so you can spot the gap.
- If both are empty: nothing is sent, and an error is recorded. The enquiry is never silently dropped.

So the way to change where a distributor's enquiries go is to edit the sales email on their record — not to change anything on this screen.

CC Email

Optional. If you would like someone at Taylor to receive a copy of every enquiry — a sales inbox, say — put that address here. Leave it blank and only the distributor is contacted.

> **CHECK THIS FIELD BEFORE YOU LAUNCH**
>
> It currently contains a placeholder address left over from testing. Either replace it with a real address or clear it — otherwise every live enquiry tries to copy somewhere that does not exist.

Quote Form ID

Tells the locator which Gravity Form is the Request Quote form. It is set to **1** and should be left alone unless the form is ever rebuilt from scratch, in which case put the new form's number here.

Section 7

Settings: HubSpot

This group connects the locator to your HubSpot account, so every enquiry also becomes a contact in your CRM. If you are not using HubSpot, leave the first box unticked and ignore the rest.

Enable HubSpot

The master switch. Leave it off until everything else is filled in and you are ready to receive live leads. When it is off, nothing is sent to HubSpot and no attempt is made.

Access Token DEVELOPER

The password-equivalent that lets your website write to your HubSpot account. Your HubSpot administrator generates it.

You can paste it here, but the better arrangement is for your developer to store it in the site's configuration file instead, where it is kept out of the database and out of backups. If they have done that, this field will show as locked, which is a good sign rather than a problem.

The field never shows a token back to you once saved — only a partial hint. Leaving it blank keeps the existing one; you cannot wipe it by accident.

API Endpoint

The address on HubSpot's system that contacts are sent to. It is filled in correctly already. The only thing to know is that this exact address must also appear in the Gravity Forms setup in Section 9 — the two have to match.

The four property fields

HubSpot stores information in named fields, and these four settings tell the locator which of yours to fill in. They are already set to the correct names for your account, verified against it directly. **Leave them as they are** unless your HubSpot administrator changes something.

SETTING	WHAT IT FILLS IN
Company Property	The company name the customer typed into the form.
Distributor Property	Which distributor the enquiry was about. Looked up from the website, not from the form, so it cannot be tampered with.
Message Property	What the customer wrote in the message box.
Lead Source Property	Records where the lead came from. Clear this field if you would rather not set a lead source at all.

> **ONE FIELD TO LEAVE STRICTLY ALONE**
>
> The **Distributor Property** must point at a free-text field in HubSpot. There is a similarly named drop-down field in your account that covers only 35 US distributors — but your list runs to more than 140 companies, most of them international.
>
> If it were pointed at the drop-down, HubSpot would quietly discard any name not on its list. Roughly three quarters of your leads would arrive with no distributor recorded, and nothing anywhere would report an error. The current setting avoids this.

Lead Source Value

The words written into the lead source field on every enquiry — currently *Distributor Locator*. This is what lets your team report on locator-generated leads separately from every other source.

Test connection

A button that checks your token works and tells you which HubSpot account it reaches. It only looks; it never creates or changes anything. Use it after entering a token, and again if HubSpot ever stops receiving enquiries.

Section 8

Settings: colours

Nine optional colour fields covering buttons, links, text, card borders, and highlights.

The recommendation is to leave all nine blank. When they are empty the locator picks up your theme's own colours automatically, which means it keeps matching your site if the brand palette is ever updated.

Set a colour only when you want the locator to differ deliberately from the rest of the site. If you do, change one at a time and look at the result — the fields cover buttons, links, and card highlights, and a change to one can affect the readability of another.

> **IF THE LOCATOR LOOKS WRONG AFTER A THEME CHANGE**
>
> Check here first. A locator that inherited its colours will follow the new theme automatically; one with colours set by hand will not, and may need those values updating.

Section 9

Connecting the quote form

One piece of setup lives outside the locator's own settings, in Gravity Forms. Without it, enquiries still reach distributors by email but never appear in HubSpot.

The hidden fields

The Request Quote form has two hidden fields that record which distributor an enquiry relates to. They are added automatically the first time the form loads — you do not need to create them, and they are meant to look empty when you view the form. **Do not delete them.**

Setting up the HubSpot connection

Only needed if you are using HubSpot. In Gravity Forms, open the Request Quote form, go to **Settings** → **Webhooks**, and add a new one:

FIELD	WHAT TO ENTER
Name	Anything recognisable — *HubSpot Contact* works well
Request URL	The same address shown in the API Endpoint setting (Section 7)
Request Method	POST
Request Format	JSON
Field mapping	**Leave empty.** The locator fills this in itself
Headers	**Do not add your token here.** It is attached automatically

Save it. That is the whole setup — the two blank sections are correct, not oversights.

> **WORTH KNOWING**
>
> If your site was copied across from a staging version, this connection came with it. Check whether one already exists before adding a second.

Spam protection

The quote form is public, which means it will eventually attract automated spam. Gravity Forms' reCAPTCHA add-on is installed and should be switched on for this form before launch. It is a five-minute job for whoever manages your forms, and it saves distributors receiving junk enquiries with your name on them.

Section 10

Placing your map pins

A pin appears on the map only once a written address has been converted into a map position. That happens automatically, but it needs an address complete enough to identify.

Running it

Go to **Distributors → Geocoding Status**. You will see how many addresses have been placed, how many are waiting, and how many could not be matched.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Run Geocoding	Places every address not yet done. Safe to run at any time.
Re-geocode All	Tries again, including addresses that failed before. Use after correcting a batch of addresses.
Cancel	Stops a run in progress.

The work happens in the background — start it and carry on with something else. A single company can also be done from the **Run Geocode** button in the distributor list.

Why an address fails

Almost always one of these: no city, no country, a PO box with no street address, a misspelled street name, or an international address written in an unfamiliar format. Correct the address on the record and run **Re-geocode All**. If it still fails, the address itself is probably wrong and worth checking with the distributor.

> **A DISTRIBUTOR WITHOUT A PIN IS NOT INVISIBLE**
>
> They still appear in every search their service area qualifies them for, with full contact details. Only the map pin is missing.

Section 11

Considerations worth your attention

Nine things that are easy to overlook and expensive to discover later. The first three are the ones that most often cause trouble.

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1. Email delivery needs setting up properly DEVELOPER

By default, websites send email in a way many mail systems treat as suspicious. Messages land in junk folders or disappear silently.

If that happens here, distributors will not receive their enquiries — and nobody would know, because the website reports everything as sent. Ask your host to configure proper email sending for the site and to add the standard sender records for your domain. It takes under an hour and it is the single most likely cause of "we never got that lead" after launch.

2. Locations and service areas are different things

This is the single most important idea in the system, and mixing the two up explains nearly every "the search is broken" report.

	PHYSICAL LOCATIONS	SERVICE ZONES
Means	Where their building is	Where they may sell
Controls	Their pin on the map	Whether they appear in a search
If empty	No pin, but still findable	**Never appears in any search**

WHY THIS MATTERS IN PRACTICE

A distributor based in Illinois who is authorised to sell into northern Mexico *should* appear when a customer in Monterrey searches their postal code — while their pin stays in Illinois. Both behaviours are correct.

And a newly added distributor with a perfect address but no service zones will have a pin on the map yet never appear in a single search result. That is the most common mistake when adding companies by hand.

3. About half your addresses cannot be mapped yet

Your records hold 685 individual addresses, of which **337 can currently be placed on the map**. The rest are missing a city, a postal code, or a country, or are PO boxes that do not correspond to a physical place.

Those distributors still appear in searches and are fully contactable — they simply have no pin, so the map looks sparser than it could. You can launch as-is, correct the worst offenders, or fix them gradually over time; the pin appears automatically once an address is complete.

4. Protect your Google Maps key DEVELOPER

The map key is visible in your website's page source — that is unavoidable and normal. What matters is that it is restricted so it only works from your own domain, and that a spending limit is set on the Google account. Without those two measures, a copied key can be used elsewhere at your expense.

5. Every HubSpot test creates a real contact

There is no separate practice environment for your HubSpot account, so any test enquiry becomes a genuine contact in your live CRM — and may trigger whatever automations you have set up.

When testing, use an email address nobody has used before, keep a note of each one, and delete the test contacts afterwards. Never test with a real customer's address.

6. Distributor email addresses are public

All five addresses on each distributor record are shown on the locator so customers can make contact. That is the point of the page, but it does mean those addresses can be collected by automated scrapers, as with any published contact page. Worth knowing before you add a personal address to a record.

7. The sales email field is doing more work than it looks

Enquiry routing depends entirely on it. Changing its *value* is normal and expected. But if anyone renames or removes the field itself, enquiries quietly start going to the fallback address instead — with no error message, and possibly weeks before anyone notices.

8. Deactivate, never delete

Switching the plugin off is completely safe and reversible. **Deleting it permanently destroys every address and service area you have entered.** If you ever believe it should be removed entirely, take a backup and an export first.

9. Always dry-run a spreadsheet import

The import screen has a dry run option that reports exactly what would change, row by row, without saving anything. It costs a minute and catches mistakes that would otherwise take hours to unpick. Export a copy of your current data first — that file is how you get back if an import goes wrong.

Section 12

Checking everything works

Run through this once after setup and before you tell anyone the page is live. Twenty minutes, and it catches almost everything.

The page itself

- [ ] The locator page loads, and the map appears rather than a blank grey area
- [ ] Pins are visible, and clusters split apart as you zoom in
- [ ] A ZIP or postal code search returns sensible results
- [ ] A state search and a country search both work
- [ ] Searching an area you know well returns the companies you expect
- [ ] Clicking a pin opens the details, with correct phone and website

The enquiry journey

- [ ] The Request Quote button opens the form
- [ ] The form submits without the page reloading, and confirms
- [ ] The enquiry arrives at the correct distributor's inbox
- [ ] If you set a CC address, it received a copy
- [ ] **Distributors** → **Routing Log** shows the enquiry with a blue Info entry
- [ ] If using HubSpot: the contact appears, with the right distributor and lead source
- [ ] Your test contacts are deleted from HubSpot afterwards

On a phone

- [ ] The map and list switch cleanly between each other
- [ ] Tapping a pin opens its details and keeps them open
- [ ] The quote form is comfortable to fill in on a small screen

Section 13

If something looks wrong

Work down the table. Most situations resolve in a couple of minutes.

WHAT YOU ARE SEEING	MOST LIKELY REASON	WHAT TO DO
The Distributors menu has vanished	Toolset Types was deactivated	Reactivate it. Your data is safe (Section 1)
The map area is blank or grey	A problem with the Google Maps account or key	Check the key and that billing is active (Section 5)
The map loads but no pins appear	Map ID missing, or addresses not yet placed	Check the Map ID, then Section 10
A distributor never appears in searches	No service zones on their record	Add the areas they cover (Section 11)
One distributor has no pin	Their address could not be matched	Check it is complete, then re-geocode
An edit is not showing on the site	A cached copy of the page	Refresh; if it persists, Clear Search Cache
A distributor says enquiries never arrive	Sales email missing or mistyped, or their spam filter	Check the Routing Log to see where it went
A distributor receives two copies	A duplicate notification on the form	Ask for help — do not change the form
Enquiries stop reaching HubSpot	The token has expired or been revoked	Use Test connection (Section 7). Emails are unaffected

EMAIL AND HUBSPOT ARE DELIBERATELY INDEPENDENT

The enquiry is emailed to the distributor first, and sent to HubSpot second. If HubSpot is down or misconfigured, **the distributor still receives the enquiry** — that was a requirement of the build and it has been tested by deliberately breaking the connection. The reverse holds too, so when something is amiss, check both rather than assuming one explains the other.

Section 14

Getting help

Before reporting anything, check the Routing Log for enquiry problems and the Geocoding Status page for map problems. They answer most questions on their own.

What to include

- The page address where you saw the problem
- What you searched for, or what you submitted
- What you expected, and what happened instead
- The date and time
- A screenshot, if there is anything to see
- For enquiry problems: the relevant line from the Routing Log

What not to do first

Two reflexes make things worse rather than better:

- **Do not delete or reinstall the plugin** to “reset” it. Deleting destroys your addresses and service areas.
- **Do not rebuild the quote form.** Rebuilding it breaks the link between enquiries and distributors, and enquiries start arriving with no way of knowing who they were for.

Almost every problem is a display or delivery issue rather than a data one, and can be corrected without touching either.

Your contacts

Support contact	_____
Hosting provider	_____
HubSpot administrator	_____
Google account owner	_____